

Books To Read, Skip, or Study.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 29, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/alb4BxBOq40> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through 9 books — self-help classics and business reads — sorting each into Skip, Read, or Study, with blunt personal takes, then promotes his own free fitness-business book.

Contents

-  Skip: The Secret
-  Study: Ready, Fire, Aim
-  Read: Think and Grow Rich
-  Read (with reservations): Atomic Habits
-  Study: The Obstacle Is the Way
-  Study: The Science of Getting Rich
-  Study: Awaken the Giant Within
-  Study: Meditations
-  Skip: The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People
-  Study: How to Make Your First 500K as an Online Trainer

Skip: The Secret [0:00](#)

- Verdict: **Skip**
 - Unless you are someone who "collects crystals," you won't get much out of it
 - His word: "You can confidently ignore it"

Study: Ready, Fire, Aim [0:00](#)

- Verdict: **Study**
 - Described as "the best book on how to build a business from scratch"
 - Covers the journey from zero to multiple millions in revenue
 - Tells you "exactly what to do at every step" of business growth

Read: Think and Grow Rich [0:00](#)

- Verdict: **Read**
 - Brandon read it at age 19 and says it "had a huge impact" on him

- Caveat: reading it once is enough — no need to revisit repeatedly

Read (with reservations): Atomic Habits 0:21

- Verdict: Read — but with a lukewarm endorsement
 - Notes that most people like it far more than he does
 - Thought it was "good" but is not enthusiastic like the majority of readers
 - "I seem to be in the minority" — acknowledges his take is contrarian

Study: The Obstacle Is the Way 0:21

- Verdict: **Study**
 - Technically categorizes it as Study, but his actual habit is re-reading it, not studying it in a traditional sense
 - Returns to it "every time [stuff] hits the fan" — a crisis-comfort read
 - Implies the book has sustained practical value across multiple life situations

Study: The Science of Getting Rich 0:21

- Verdict: **Study**
 - Law of attraction style book, but Brandon highlights one specific, standout idea
 - The key principle (written in ALL CAPS in the book): **"Do all that can be done each day"**
 - This is not sometimes, not most of the time, not a lot — it means *every single day*
 - Brandon's argument: "If you do all that can be done each day, it's difficult to fail"
 - His observation: "Nobody does that" — which is why most people don't succeed
 - Self-exception: "except for me and the rest of the ballers"

Study: Awaken the Giant Within 0:45

- Verdict: **Study**
 - Says it "completely changed my life" — his strongest personal endorsement
 - Specific advice: get the **physical book** (not digital) and read it

Study: Meditations 0:45

- Verdict: **Study**
 - Calls it "the best book on stoicism"
 - Focus: how to be mentally stronger

"I think this should be required reading for anybody who wants to accomplish anything important in their lives."

✗ Skip: The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People 1:07

- Verdict: **Skip**
 - Read it once; reaction was underwhelmed — "I was like, uh"
 - No elaboration given; dismissal is brief and confident

👤 Study: How to Make Your First 500K as an Online Trainer 1:07

- Verdict: **Study** — his most emphatic recommendation in the video
 - Written by Brandon Carter himself
 - Describes it as the only book he knows of that shows how to grow an online fitness business to maximum earnings
 - **It's free** — comment the word "grow" on the video and he will send it directly
 - Advice: "Study it with a fine-tooth comb"